



AnimeDL

SELF-HOSTED ANIME DOWNLOADER

What is AnimeDL?

AnimeDL is a self-hosted web application that lets you search, browse, and download anime episodes directly to your machine. No ads, no trackers, no accounts. Everything runs locally on your own computer.

The frontend is a clean black-and-white React interface. The backend is a Python FastAPI server that talks to the Allanime API for episode metadata, then uses yt-dlp to fetch the actual video files from streaming sources.

PAGES

ROUTE	PAGE	WHAT IT DOES
/	Home	Trending + popular shows, genre filters, search bar
/search	Search	Text search with genre filters and results grid
/anime/:id	Detail	Episode grid, dub/sub toggle, quality selector, batch download
/downloads	Downloads	Active download progress, stop all, completed history
/history	History	Previously downloaded shows — click to resume
/setup	Setup	In-app guide (this document is the offline version)

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Prerequisites

Before you can run AnimeDL, you need these four tools installed on your system:

TOOL	VERSION	PURPOSE
Python	3.11+	Runs the FastAPI backend server
Node.js	20+	Runs the Vite frontend dev server
yt-dlp	latest	Downloads video from streaming sources
ffmpeg	latest	Merges separate video and audio streams (DASH)

INSTALLATION

```
# Python / yt-dlp
pip install yt-dlp

# ffmpeg (pick one for your OS)
sudo apt install ffmpeg          # Debian / Ubuntu
sudo pacman -S ffmpeg           # Arch Linux
brew install ffmpeg              # macOS

# Node.js – download from https://nodejs.org or use nvm
```

VERIFY

Run `python3 --version`, `node --version`, `yt-dlp --version`, and `ffmpeg -version` to confirm everything is installed.

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Quick Start

From a terminal:

```
# 1. Clone the repository
git clone https://github.com/wyrmic-arch/AnimeDL.git
cd AnimeDL

# 2. Install backend dependencies
cd backend
pip install -r requirements.txt
cd ..

# 3. Install frontend dependencies
cd frontend
npm install
cd ..

# 4. Start both servers
bash start.sh
```

Open **http://localhost:5173** in your browser.

STOPPING THE SERVERS

```
kill $(lsof -ti:8000) $(lsof -ti:5173) 2>/dev/null
```

PERSISTENT DAEMONS

Both servers run as daemons (via `setsid`) — they survive terminal disconnects. Use the kill command above to stop them.

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How to Use

The download workflow is straightforward: search, select, download, watch.

01 SEARCH

Use the search bar on the home page, or browse trending and popular shows. Filter by genre to narrow down your options.

Every result shows the cover image, episode count, and dub availability.

02 SELECT

Choose Dub or Sub mode, pick your preferred quality, and select individual episodes — or use "Select All" for a full batch.

Previously downloaded episodes are marked with a check and a strikethrough.

03 DOWNLOAD

Hit the download button. Multiple episodes run in parallel (up to 3 at a time). Progress is shown in real time — the episode number gradually turns white.

You can stop all active downloads from the Downloads page at any time.

04 WATCH

Find your files in the destination folder (default: `~/Videos/anime/`). Each show gets its own subfolder; files are named by episode number.

Features

Search Find any anime by name or filter by genre	Trending / Popular Browse what's hot right now on the home page
Cover Images Thumbnails, descriptions, genres, and status badges	Dub / Sub Toggle Switch between English dub and subbed episodes
Quality Selection Choose 360p, 480p, 720p, 1080p, or best available	Batch Download Select multiple episodes; runs up to 3 in parallel
Real-time Progress Episode numbers fade toward white as they download	Stop All Cancel every active download with one click
Download History Every completed episode is saved — pick up where you left off	Search History Recent searches appear in the dropdown when you focus the search bar
Recommendations Trending shows shown in the search dropdown for discovery	Custom Destination Choose where downloaded files are saved on your machine

SEARCH DROPDOWN

Clicking the search input opens a dropdown with your recent search history (with a CLEAR button) and trending recommendations with cover images and episode counts. Click any item to jump directly to that show or search.

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Tips & Notes

ENGLISH DUB

English dubs are preferred when available. The Dub tab shows all episodes with English audio. The Sub tab shows original Japanese with subtitles.

SURVIVING DISCONNECTS

Both servers run as daemons using `setsid`. You can close the terminal or SSH session — the servers keep running. Use the kill command to stop them.

RESUME DOWNLOADS

If a download is interrupted (e.g., you stop all downloads or the server restarts), yt-dlp will resume partial files on the next attempt. No need to re-download from scratch.

HISTORY PERSISTENCE

Download history and search history are stored in your browser's localStorage. Clearing your browser data will clear it. The History page lets you pick up where you left off on any show.

SOURCE PRIORITY

The backend tries multiple source servers for each episode. Direct links from `tools.fast4speed.rsvp` are preferred (fastest and most reliable). If a source fails, the next one is tried automatically.

NEED HELP?

Open an issue on GitHub: <https://github.com/wyrmic-arch/AnimeDL/issues>

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API Reference

The backend exposes a REST API and a WebSocket endpoint. All endpoints are prefixed with `/api`.

METHOD	PATH	DESCRIPTION
GET	<code>/api/search?q=&genres=&sort_by=</code>	Search anime by name and genre
GET	<code>/api/trending</code>	Get trending shows (24 results)
GET	<code>/api/popular</code>	Get most popular shows (24 results)
GET	<code>/api/anime/{id}</code>	Full show detail with episodes, description, genres
GET	<code>/api/anime/{id}/sources/{ep}?mode=</code>	Source URLs for one episode
POST	<code>/api/download</code>	Start a download task
GET	<code>/api/download/{task_id}</code>	Check task status
GET	<code>/api/download/{task_id}/file</code>	Serve completed video file
GET	<code>/api/downloads</code>	List all download tasks
POST	<code>/api/downloads/stop</code>	Stop all active downloads
WS	<code>/ws/download/{task_id}</code>	Real-time download progress stream

WEBSOCKET MESSAGES

Each message is a JSON object with the task's current status, progress percentage, download speed, and ETA. The stream stays open until the download finishes or fails.

Project Structure

```
AnimeDL/
├── backend/
│   ├── main.py          # FastAPI routes, CORS, WebSocket
│   ├── allanime.py      # Allanime API client (search, detail, AES decrypt)
│   ├── downloader.py    # yt-dlp subprocess management
│   ├── models.py        # Pydantic schemas
│   └── requirements.txt
├── frontend/
│   ├── src/
│   │   ├── App.tsx
│   │   ├── api.ts        # Typed fetch wrappers
│   │   ├── history.ts    # localStorage download/search history
│   │   ├── pages/        # LandingPage, SearchPage, AnimePage, ...
│   │   ├── components/   # AnimeCard, Navbar, SearchDropdown
│   │   └── styles/global.css
│   └── package.json
├── start.sh
├── guide.html           # This document (HTML source)
├── guide.pdf            # This document (PDF)
└── README.md
```

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License

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BUILT WITH

[FastAPI](#)

Python web framework

[React](#) + [Vite](#)

Frontend framework and build tool

[yt-dlp](#)

Video download engine

[Allanime](#)

Anime metadata API